WELCOME

Welcome to ORG

The Octagon Religious Research Group: where the proposals, the procedures and the decks live, how a change travels, and how to answer

A first walk for a newcomer, and for the AI helper beside them. Every slide points at a real page; the deck only shows the order to open them in.

What you will find here

Kind	What it is	Where
The reading room	one shelf for everything ORG has chosen to share, in a browser	the public shelf · the members' room
Procedures (SOPs)	*this is how we do it now*, approved versions tagged	ORG procedures, public
Proposals	*should we?* One folder, one page, a PDF beside it	`proposals` (members)
Decks	walk-throughs like this one, for a call or a first look	`.github/decks/`

> Everything ORG writes wears the same colour, these four shades of emerald, so you can tell whose page it is before you read a word.

The public shelf and the public procedures opened in October 2026 with empty shelves; officers add pages one at a time. A link marked (members) asks you to sign in.

Five words, and you can find your way

Word	Means
Repository	a folder that remembers every change and who made it
Pull request	a proposed change, waiting for a person to read it and merge it
`preview` **and** `main`	the rehearsal copy and the live copy of the same folder, where a repository has both
Public twin	a public copy that carries only the pages marked public; nobody edits it by hand
Issue	a conversation thread: the easiest way to ask or answer

You never need to type a branch command. You read, you comment, and you say yes or no.

How a proposal reads

1. **TL;DR**: five lines, the only part you have to read.
2. **What is offered**: how things are today, beside what is proposed.
3. **Decisions log**: what was chosen, when, and by whom. Yours stay blank until you choose.
4. **Asks**: usually none, sometimes one.
5. **Sources, and what could not be confirmed**: folded away, never hidden.

Every proposal comes as a **PDF for your eyes** and the **markdown it was made from** for your helper's. Members start with **000 Start here** and **001 ORG's Welcome Map** in `proposals`; the vote itself happens in **ORG (Voting)** on Telegram.

Procedures: how we do it now

- A procedure is named `SOP-<Department>-<ID>-<name>`: `SOP-OPS-001` is the first operations procedure.
- It is a **draft** until the officers tag an approved version; the tag is the approval.
- Each one opens with a badge row: the number in **ORG's emerald**, its status, the date it last changed, and **For** in the slate every organisation shares.
- Every procedure is also a PDF, rendered on each push.

> Read **SOP-OPS-001 "How a change travels"** first. It is the road two slides on, in full.

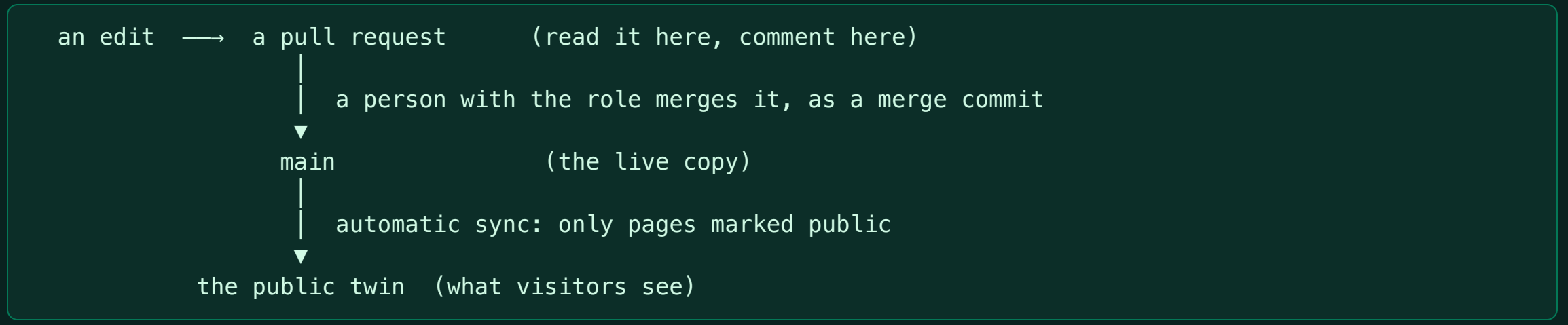
The procedures visitors may read: ops-standard-operating-procedures-public. Members read all of them, drafts included, in the members' room.

The reading room, and your helper

- **The public shelf**, octagon-religious-research-group-org.github.io/reading-room-public: the decks and procedures ORG has chosen to share. Anyone can open it.
- **The members' room**, `reading-room`: proposals, procedures and decks as PDFs. Open it signed in to GitHub. A **404** means signed out or not yet in the **readers** team: ask ORG at org@orgspirituality.org.
- **Your helper** (Claude, ChatGPT, any of them) can read the same pages once it is connected with your permission, never more than you can. Point it at the markdown, not the PDF, and start it with the welcome for your helper (members).

> A good first question for your helper: "*Read 000 Start here and tell me what is waiting for my answer.*"

The road a change travels



- ORG's repositories take pull requests straight into `main` today. Where a repository keeps a `preview` branch, the edit rehearses there first and the pull request is called **Promote: …** (what it carries).
- If a link to `main` still shows old words while someone says the change is done, the pull request (or the Promote) has not been merged yet.
- A page that is not marked public never leaves the private repository, on any branch.

How to answer

You want to…	Do this
say yes, no, or "not yet" to a proposal	vote in **ORG (Voting)** on Telegram, or open an **issue** titled with its number
comment on a change before it goes live	comment on its **pull request**
ask a question about a procedure	open an issue in the procedures repository, naming the SOP
ask your helper to answer for you	let it draft; **you** read it and post it under your name
get access, or more of it	write to ORG at org@orgspirituality.org, saying which GitHub account is yours

> There is no wrong door. A question in the wrong place gets moved, not lost.

Who to ask

ORG, at org@orgspirituality.org, or in ORG (Public) on Telegram

- for access to the reading room, the proposals or the procedures
- when a link shows 404, or a page looks out of date
- when you are not sure where an answer belongs

Every way to reach ORG is on its contacts page. For GitHub itself, the technical steward is **Christopher W** (@drasticstatic). Nobody at ORG ever needs your password or a code.

Where to start next: the public shelf, then **SOP-OPS-001** in the public procedures, then, as a member, **000 Start here** in `proposals`.